# COLD CALL SCRIPT: QUESTION OPENER

## The opener:

Hey, is this [first name]? It's [your name] with Rightway Growth.

The reason for the call is I have a question for you about [business].

Rightway Growth helps businesses get the leads they want at the peak of their interest, which is while they're on Google searching. Kind of like live strategy in your pocket.

So I'm curious, how are you handling new leads for jobs right now?

Or (shorter): The reason for the call is I have a question for you about [business]. We help [industry] businesses get calls from people on Google right now looking for what you do. So I'm curious, how are most new jobs coming in for you these days?

Or (permission first): I know I'm calling out of the blue. Can I take 30 seconds to tell you why I called, and you tell me if I'm off base?

*DO: Ask the question, then stop talking. Silence is fine. Let them answer.*

## Their current state:

How are most new customers finding you right now? (call prep shows the question for their trade)

Then: Where did your last few new customers come from?

Then: Is that the kind of work you want more of?

Then: Are you looking for more jobs, or better quality ones?

*DO: The goal is to get them talking about where work comes from now. Listen for a problem you can help with. If it really works and they are happy, that is a fine answer: thank them and exit.*

## Mirror and label what they say:

*DO: Mirror their last one to three words as a question, pause four seconds, then label it. One label, then one how or what question. Never why.*

IF Referrals and word of mouth: Word of mouth? (pause) It sounds like your reputation does the selling. When a friend sends someone your way, what do you think they do first, call you or look you up?

IF They have a system: Already have a system? (pause) It sounds like you have a good system in place to get calls in. What part of it brings in the jobs you want most?

IF Google already sends calls: Google sends you calls? (pause) It sounds like Google is already working for you. Which parts of town do those calls come from, and which never call?

IF Angi, Thumbtack, HomeAdvisor or Yelp: Angi? (pause) It sounds like the leads come in, but you are racing other guys for them. When a lead comes in, how many others are calling that same person?

IF Ads or Local Services Ads: Running ads? (pause) It sounds like you pay for every call. What happens to the calls on the days the budget runs out?

IF Slammed or booked out: Slammed? (pause) It sounds like you can pick your jobs. If you could choose, what kind of jobs would you take more of?

IF Slow or quiet: Slow? (pause) It seems like it has been quieter than you would like. What happens in the slow weeks?

IF Has an agency or a guy: Have a guy? (pause) It sounds like you are covered. How do you know it is working? What do they show you each month?

IF Tried it before, got burned: Got burned? (pause) It sounds like you paid and never saw the work. What went wrong, the work or the results?

IF Not sure where calls come from: Not sure? (pause) It sounds like the calls just show up. How do you know which marketing is paying off?

IF Missed calls: Miss some? (pause) It sounds like the phone rings when you are on a job. When you are on a job and it rings, what happens to that call?

IF Reviews: Reviews? (pause) It seems like asking for them feels awkward. When did the last one come in?

## Sum it up:

So it sounds like most of your work comes from [your words for where work comes from], and [your words for the problem they named]. Did I get that right?

*DO: Wait for "That's right." If you hear "You're right", label it: It sounds like I missed something. What did I get wrong?*

## Ask for time:

It sounds like there are a few ways I could help you get more quality jobs in the door that I'd love to show you.

It seems like there's some low hanging fruit here. I'd love to show you how the [industry] shops at the top of the map near you are getting their calls.

Would it be crazy to grab a quick screen share, [time 1] or [time 2]?

*Or:* Are you available today or tomorrow for a chat? I have [time 1] or [time 2].

*DO: Sell the time, nothing else. Price never comes up before the pitch. If they ask: there's a lot we can provide, but it only matters if it gets you results. We're performance based, so price comes after we know what you need.*

## Lock it in:

Perfect. What's the best email for the invite?

So [time 1], and you'll be near a computer or your phone? *(Wait for "That's right.")*

What could come up that would make that time a problem?

*DO: Say the day and time back out loud. Book it in the Hub before you hang up.*

## Rebuttals (mirror, label, ask):

*DO: Every answer starts with a mirror or a label, then one how or what question, then back to the time ask. Full list in Mirror and label below the script.*

"Not interested."

Totally fair, you didn't ask for my call. It sounds like Google isn't a headache right now. How are most new customers finding you these days?

"Just send me an email."

Some info? Happy to. So I don't send you junk, what would actually be useful to you?

"We already have someone."

Already have someone? (pause) Good, so you already believe in it. How do you know it's working?

"We get enough from word of mouth."

Word of mouth? Best kind of customer. When a friend says call [business], what do you think they do first, dial straight or look you up?

"How much does it cost?"

How much? Fair question. Honestly, there's a lot we can provide, but it only matters if it gets you results. We're a performance based company, so I'd

never put a price on it before we know what you actually need. That's what the screen share is for. [time 1] or [time 2]?

"We tried it before and it didn't work."

It sounds like you paid and got nothing to show for it. What went wrong: you couldn't see the work, or the results never came?

"I'm busy."

It sounds like I caught you mid job. Give me 20 seconds on why I called, then you decide if it's worth a callback?

"Is this a sales call?"

It is, and you can hang up in 30 seconds if it's off. Fair?

## **Mirror and label:**

“Not interested.”

Totally fair, you didn't ask for my call. It sounds like Google isn't a headache right now. How are most new customers finding you these days?

“Just send me an email.”

Some info? Happy to. So I don't send you junk, what would actually be useful: How you show up on the map, or who is taking those calls instead?

“I'm busy right now.”

It sounds like I caught you mid job. Give me 20 seconds on why I called, then you decide if it's worth a callback?

“Call me back later.”

Later? Sure. What time is actually good, so I'm not interrupting you twice?

“Is this a sales call?”

It is, and you can hang up in 30 seconds if it's off. Fair? I'm calling about how [business] shows up on Google in [city]. How much of your work comes from Google today?

“I get 10 calls a day from people like you.”

You probably think I'm call number eleven promising page one. I'm not, nobody can promise that. What do the other ten usually get wrong?

“How did you get my number?”

Fair question. It's the number on your Google listing. I called because of how that listing shows up in [city]. Want me to take you off our list, or give me 30 seconds?

“Is this AI / a robot?”

Ha, real person, slightly nervous. It sounds like you've had a few robots this week. What do they usually call about?

“I don't do anything over the phone.”

Good rule, honestly. Nothing gets bought on this call. What way would you feel safe looking at it: A screen share, a link, or in person?

“I'm in a meeting / with a customer.”

It sounds like a bad moment, I'll be quick. When's better, end of today or tomorrow morning?

“We get enough work from word of mouth.”

Word of mouth? Best kind of customer. When a friend says call [business], what do you think they do first, dial straight or look you up?

“We're slammed, too busy for more work.”

Slammed is a good problem. If you could pick, what kind of jobs would you take more of, and drop?

“We're not looking to grow.”

It sounds like you've got it where you want it. How would you know if a competitor started taking your spot on Google?

“We're a small shop.”

Small shop, so every call counts. When someone nearby searches [industry], who usually shows up above you?

“We're already on Google.”

Good, so Google's already working for you. Which parts of town do those calls come from, and which ones never call?

“Reviews don't matter in my business.”

It sounds like your work speaks for itself. When a new customer is choosing between you and the shop down the street, what do you think tips it?

“My customers don't use Google.”

They don't use Google? Interesting. What about someone new in town who's never heard of you, how do they find you?

“Google is a scam.”

It sounds like Google burned you somewhere. What happened?

“We're new, we just started.”

Congrats on opening. How are your first customers finding you so far?

“We're about to sell / retire.”

Congrats. How far out is that?

“Bad timing, it's our slow season.”

It sounds like a slow stretch. When does the busy season usually pick up?

“Call me after the season.”

After the season? Makes sense. When does it wind down, and what day should I call?

“We already have someone / an agency.”

Good, so you already believe in it. How do you know it is working, do they show you where you show up around town?

“My nephew / my guy does it.”

Love that it stays in the family. What does he mostly handle, the website, social or the Google listing?

“We do it ourselves.”

Respect that. How much of your week does it eat up?

“We tried SEO before and it didn't work.”

It sounds like you paid and got nothing to show for it. What went wrong: You could not see the work, or the results never came?

“We use Angi / Thumbtack / HomeAdvisor / Yelp.”

Angi brings jobs, sure. When a lead comes in, how many other guys are calling that same person?

“We run Google Ads / Local Services Ads.”

Smart, ads get calls fast. What happens to the calls on the days the budget runs out?

“We're a franchise, corporate handles marketing.”

Makes sense. Does corporate handle your location's own Google listing and reviews, or just the brand?

“How much does it cost?”

How much? Fair question. Honestly, there's a lot we can provide, but it only matters if it gets you results. We're a performance based company, so I'd never put a price on it before we know what you actually need. What would good results look like for you?

“We don't have the budget.”

Totally get it. It sounds like money is going to bigger things right now. We're performance based, so it only makes sense if it pays for itself. What would have to happen for marketing to make the list?

“SEO is too expensive.”

Too expensive? It sounds like you've been quoted big numbers for things that didn't pay off. Honestly, there's a lot we can provide, but it only matters if it gets you results. We're a performance based company, so I'd never put a price on it before we know what you actually need. What would one extra good job a month be worth to you?

“Send me a proposal / pricing.”

Pricing? Happy to, once there's something real to price. Honestly, there's a lot we can provide, but it only matters if it gets you results. We're a performance based company, so I'd never put a price on it before we know what you actually need. What would you want it to fix first?

“Let me think about it.”

Makes sense. It sounds like something's not sitting right. What's the part you'd be thinking over?

“Can you guarantee first page?”

No, and anyone who guarantees a spot isn't being straight with you. What I can promise is you'll see the work and your map every month. What would good look like to you?

“What makes you different?”

On paper, we look like everyone. The difference is you see the work and your map every month, month to month after the first three. Does that matter to you?

“I don't trust agencies.”

You're probably thinking I'm just another agency that'll take your money. What would someone have to show you to earn a little trust?

“Are you calling from Google?”

No, not Google. Rightway Growth, a local marketing company. I'm calling about how you show up on Google. Want 30 seconds, or should I let you go?

“I'm not the owner / he's not here.”

No worries, maybe you can help. When is the best time to catch the owner, mornings or after 5?

“The owner doesn't take these calls.”

It sounds like they get a lot of these. It is about how [business] shows up on Google here. How would they prefer to get something like that, email or a voicemail?

“What's this regarding?”

Sure. I'm [your name] with Rightway Growth. It's about how [business] shows up on Google Maps in [city]. Is the owner around for a minute?

“Talk to my partner / spouse.”

Makes sense, big decisions should be together. What would they want to see? Can we find a time you are both free, [time 1] or [time 2]?

“Not my responsibility / wrong person.”

Thanks for telling me. Who handles how the business shows up online?

“Leave a message / put it in writing.”

Sure. Could you tell them [your name] called about their Google map results, and I'll try again tomorrow?

“We're closed, call during hours.”

Sorry, my mistake. When is best to catch the owner?